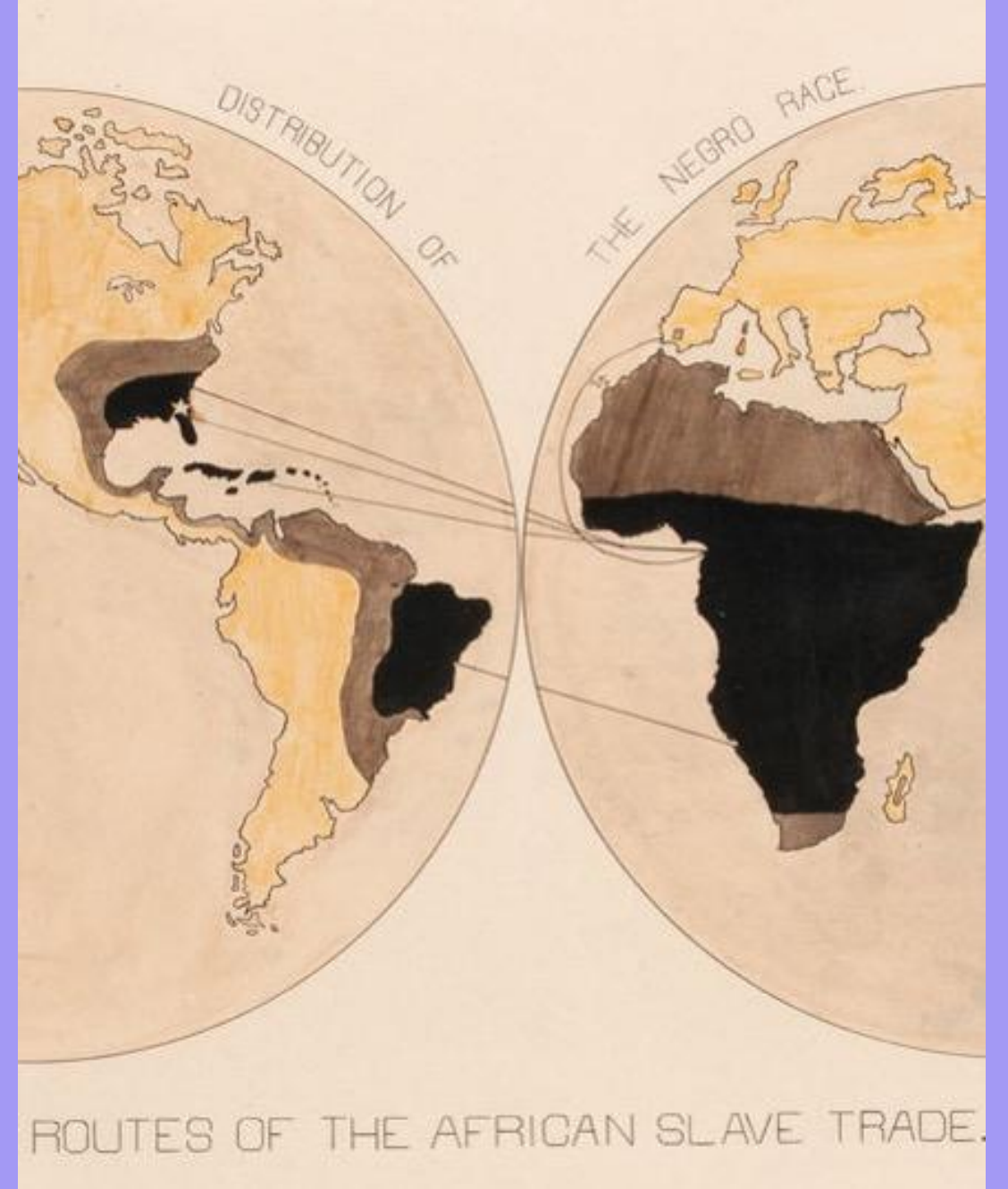


Inclusive Mapping Workshop: Creating a Design Brief

24 October 2025 | Webinar

Part of the ESRC's Digital Good Network Project:
***Can Digital Goods be Neutral? Evaluating OpenStreetMap's
Equity Through Participatory Data Visualisations***

**UNIVERSITY
OF WARWICK**



Thank you!

Because your participation will be key at providing insights for our research project.

On the other hand, we expect **that by the end of today you will**

- Have a renewed understanding of the relationship between maps, inequalities and neutrality,
- Have an opportunity to reflect and discuss about the role of maps to promote/hamper equity and inclusion
- Have met nice and interesting people.
- Have fun!

About us



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Meg Davis (University of Warwick)
Selene Yang (University of

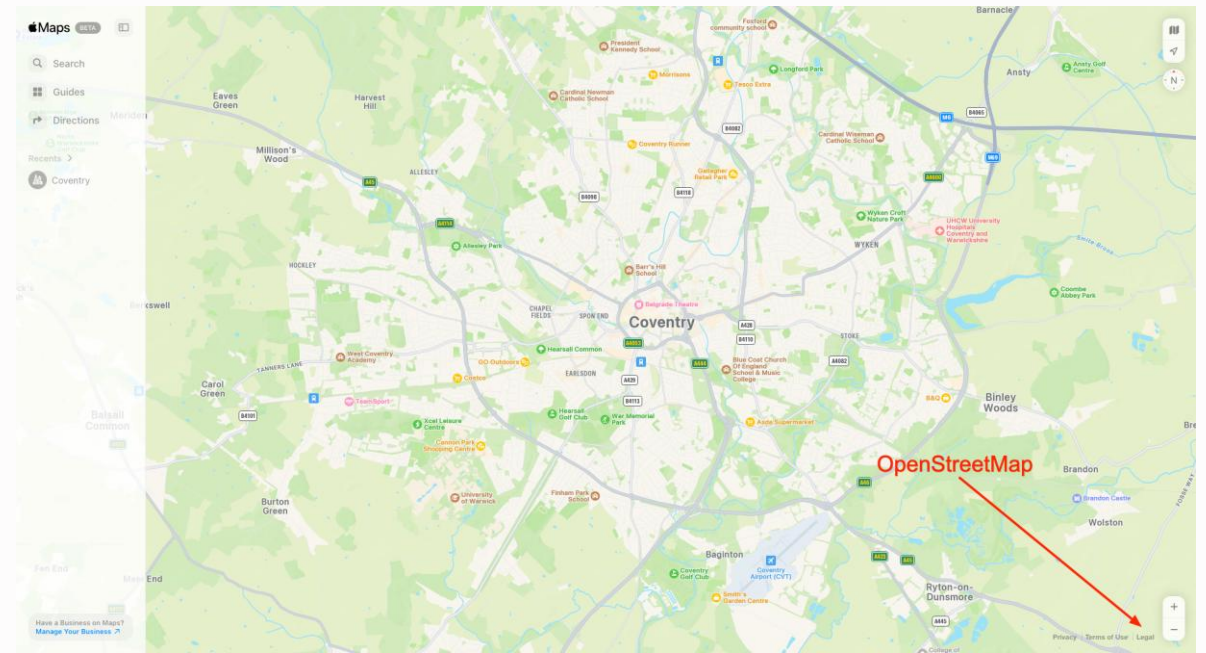
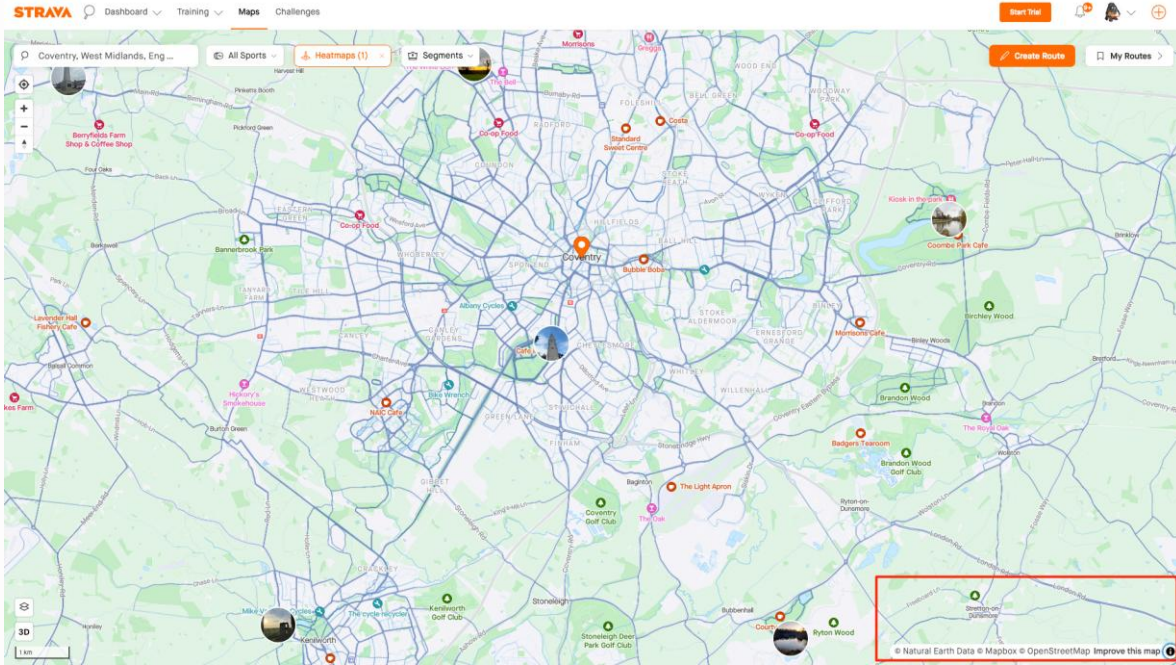
About the project



Can Digital Goods be Neutral?

Evaluating OpenStreetMap's equity through participatory data visualisation.

- One of the 9 funded projects by the **ESRC Digital Good Network** (Research Fund 2024)
- Our research enquires about how **neutrality** is operationalised to favour or hinder **equity** in a particular digital good:
OpenStreetMap.



Its data, contributed by 10 million of volunteers, complements official data sources, and **populates thousands of tools and services**.

Major Sites: Amazon, Apple, Baidu Maps, Facebook, Microsoft, Wikipedia and Wikimedia

Transport: Air France, Alaska Airlines, Deutsche Bahn, Grab, SNCF (French rail agency), Uber

Geodata Software and Services: CARTO, Digital Globe, ESRI, Garmin, Mapbox, Telenav

Government: Agence Française de Développement, Government of Brazil, Government of Italy: President's Office, Police Scotland, US National Park Service, US State Department, USAID, Peace Corps....

Like Wikipedia, **OSM is based on principles of openness and neutrality.**

“OpenStreetMap maps world as it exists, and includes mapping borders and countries according to actual current situation and **not a preferred or ideal situation**” ([OSM Wiki](#))

What do maps have to do with gender? Aren't they objective?
Can you give **examples**?

That's what we are asked a lot when we present our project.
And that's why we are here today!

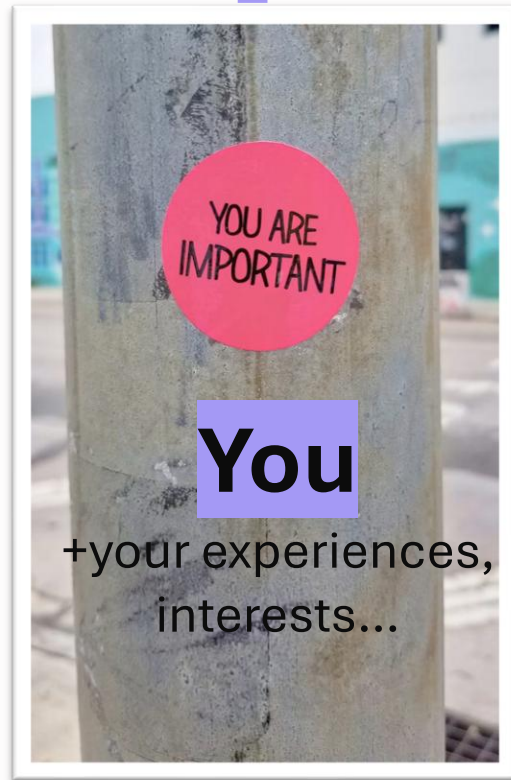
Inclusive cartographies workshop series

Producing the brief

18th October, 24th October (online)

Producing the cartographic style

27th October



Online evaluation

Aims and agenda

Produce a **design brief** for an **inclusive cartography**

10:00 – 10:15

Introductions

10:15 – 10:30

Task 1: From maps to briefs

10:30 – 11:40

Task 2: Creating the design brief (group activity)

11:40 – 12:00

Evaluation and farewell

Name of the map: London's Cycling 'Super Highways'

Team members: name 1, nickname 2, ...

Goals

Which questions/problems/situations do you think this map is trying to address?

- Show London's main cycling routes in a simple, clear, map
- speculate about what a 'cycling friendly' London could look like
- see cycling as equal to other public transport
- Easily understandable and digestible

Audience

What group(s) of people would benefit the most from using this map?

- Londoners who are already familiar with the city's geography
- cyclists who could use this map like an underground map
- Policymakers and activists advocating for cycling infrastructure

Example use

How do you see your map being used?

- Deciding new cycling routes
- Planning new cycling infrastructure
- Promoting Active Travel

Map Features

What features are most important to your map?

- Cycling 'super highways'
- Links to other public transport
- Area names to locate ourselves
- Parks and squares + water bodies

Sketch/Drawing/Image



Map Anti Features

What is not important to your map?

- Buildings
- Shops and amenities
- Tourist attractions
- Cycling 'unfriendly roads and routes'

Design Considerations

What kind of design will make your map work best? eg Styles, Colours, size, shapes, icons

- Like the tube map in style but with distances preserved
- Different colours for different lines
- Line types (filled, no-fill) for different types?
- Coloured Areas for main parks and water banks (e.g. Thames) for quickly positioning

Housekeeping

We will speak about potentially sensitive topics: gender, race, sexual orientation...

- No need to disclose any personal information
 - Optionally: Mediated through the use of fictional personas
- Be respectful and considerate with each other

We will be collecting the following information:

- Photos* and recordings
- Workshop's materials (Personas, Maps...)
- Anonymous survey
- Notes (see Chatham House rules)

* If you want to opt out, please let us know.

“ anyone is free to use information from the discussion/workshop, but is not allowed to reveal who made any particular comment.

Chatham House Rules



We'd love to hear your thoughts!

Discussion (30')

Illustrative questions

1. Any thoughts on:
 1. Maps (and equity)
 2. OpenStreetMap
 3. What we did today
2. Will you be using any of the things you learnt today in the future?
3. How far did you manage to progress?
4. Is there anything you've done or learnt today you'd want to share with the participants?
5. How important would you say it is to have equitable maps?

Evaluation (5')

Please, fill this short survey (3 questions)

https://warwick.co1.qualtrics.com/jfe/form/SV_6zHI239o75rvKoC



Thank you!

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